System.

CAP HEIGHT TO BASELINE

INTER TIGHT 600 · −6.5% TRACKING

BRAND & PRODUCT MANUAL

A blueprint for brands that start from type and grid, and add a logo, icons and pictures when they have them.

WEB · APPS · TYPE · MARKETING

SHEETS 00–16

Contents

Every sheet is optional. Switch off what the client doesn’t bring, and the manual falls back to type and grid instead of leaving a hole.

02	Landing	WEB
03	Logo	IDENTITY
04	Color	IDENTITY
05	Typography	IDENTITY
06	Grid	LAYOUT
07	Icons	IDENTITY
08	Imagery	IDENTITY
09	Components	PRODUCT
10	Apps	PRODUCT
11	Motion	PRODUCT
12	Voice	WRITING
13	Marketing	MEDIA
14	Print	MEDIA
15	Downloads	FILES
16	Utility	WEB
00	Cover	↑

WITH / WITHOUT — SET AT SETUP

Logo	WITH / WITHOUT
Icon set	WITH / WITHOUT
Imagery	WITH / WITHOUT

FALLBACKS — NEVER AN EMPTY SLOT

Each switch flips its sheets between the client’s assets and the template’s own fallback: a typographic wordmark for the logo, mono glyph cells for the icons, and drafting frames for the pictures.

Landing

One column of argument: a headline that says what it is, one action, then three reasons. The grid lines keep running behind it.

SYSTEM.EXAMPLE

System.

PRODUCT PRICING DOCS

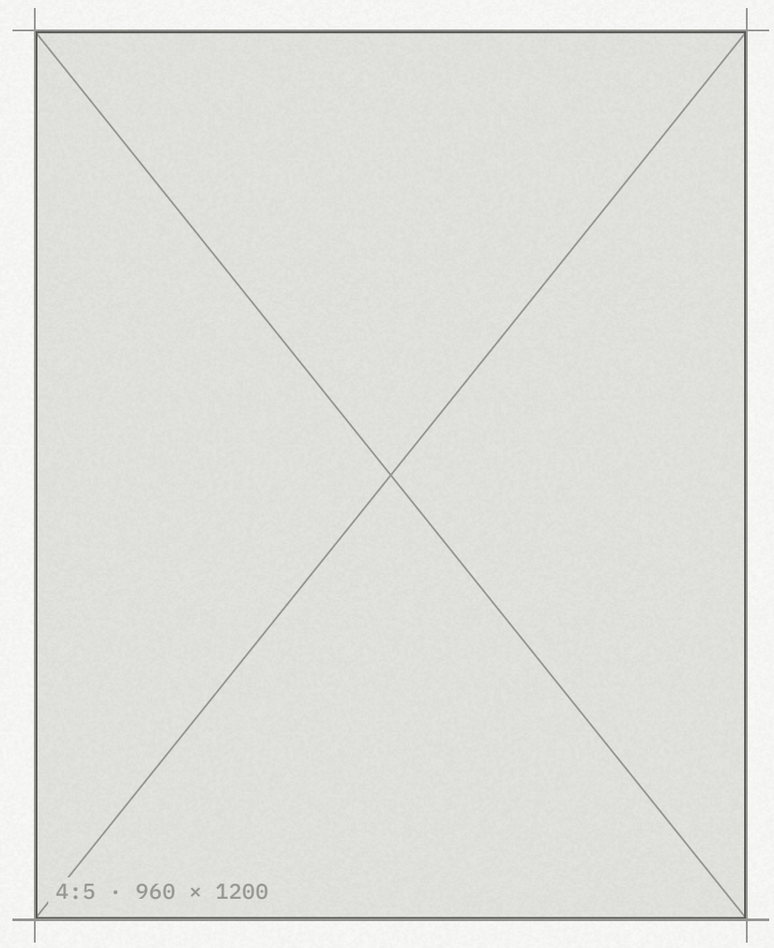
Sign in

Build the brand once, use it everywhere

Type, grid and color set up as one system, so the website, the app and the posters come out looking related.

Get the files

Read the manual



One source

Tokens live in one file. Change the accent there and every sheet updates.

Works without assets

No logo or icon set yet? Type and grid carry the identity until they arrive.

Ships as files

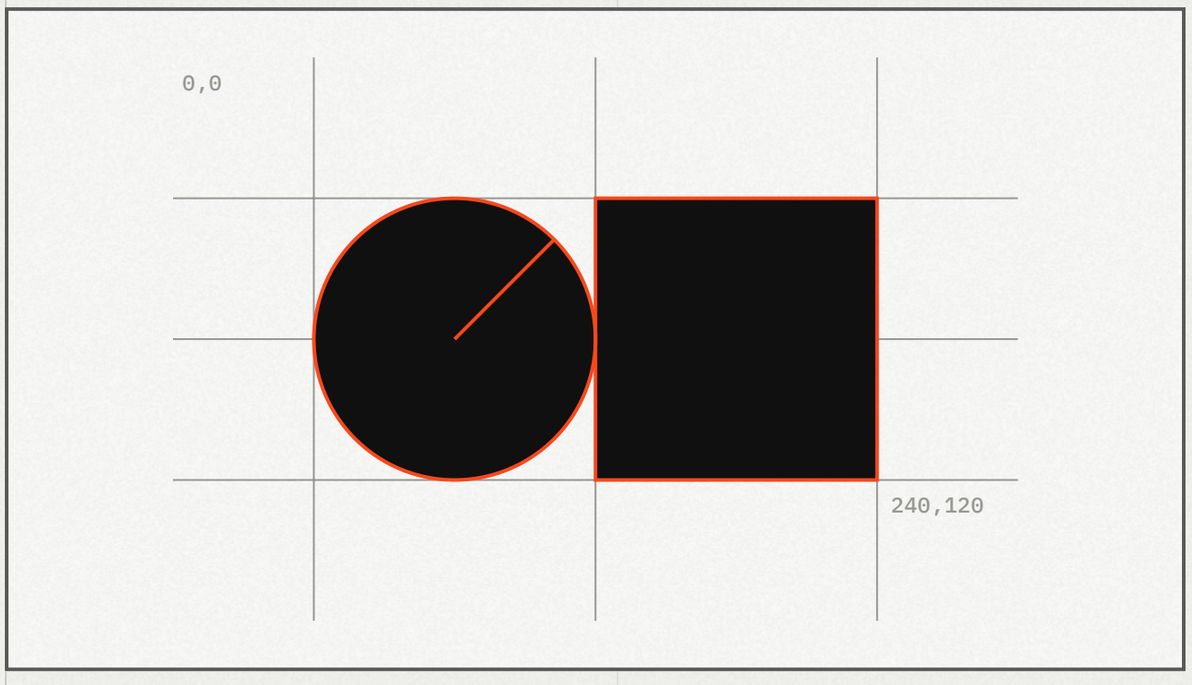
Logos, tokens and print PDFs come out of one script, ready to send.

Logo

The mark is a circle and a square of equal height. Keep half the mark height clear around the logo, and two thirds after the name, so the open end of the word balances the mark.

CONSTRUCTION

R = 1 UNIT



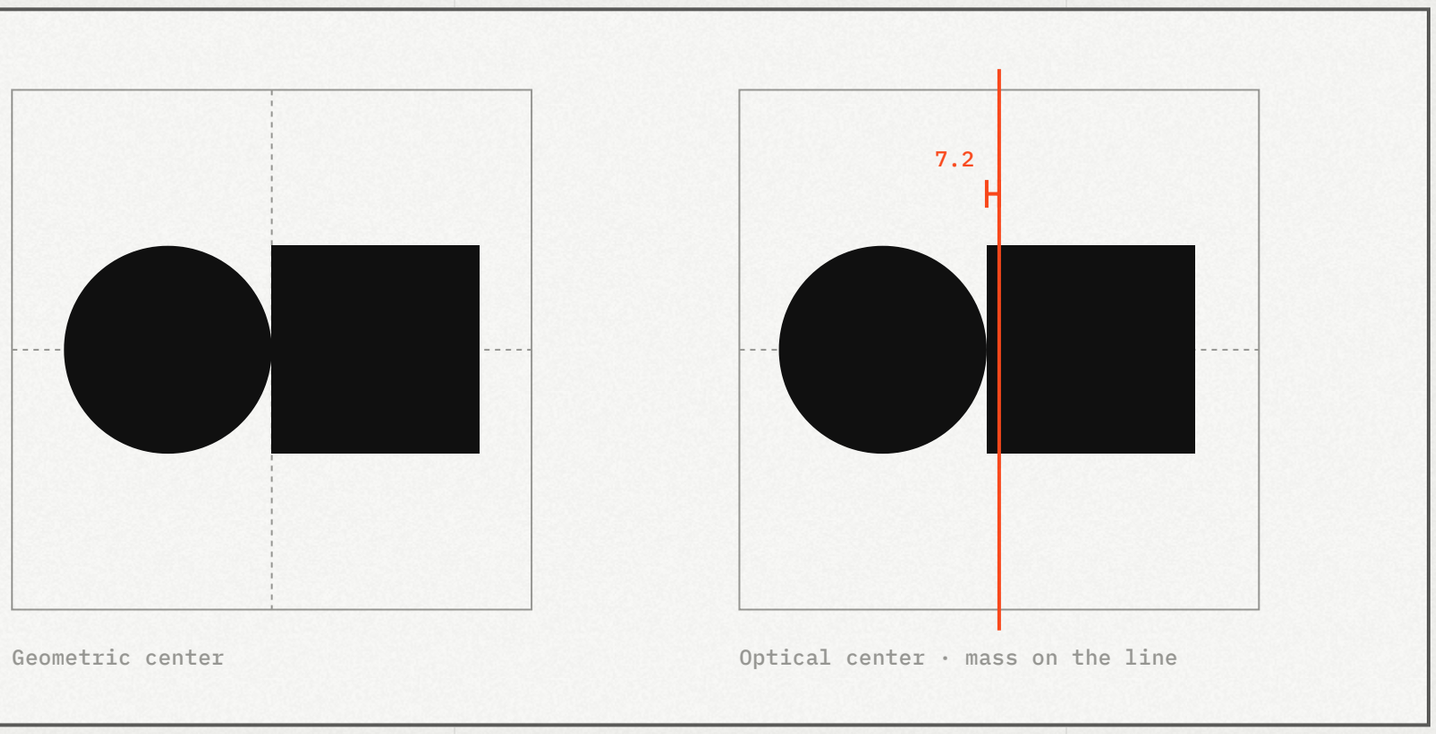
CLEAR SPACE

1/2 AND 2/3 OF THE MARK HEIGHT



OPTICAL CENTER

SHIFT 7.2 = 3% OF THE WIDTH



WHY

MARK ALONE

The square is heavier

It holds 14 400 units² against the circle's 11 310, so the mark's center of mass sits at 127.2 of its 240, not at 120.

Shift it 7.2 left

Wherever the mark stands alone and centered, on the splash, app icons and avatars, move it 3% of its width to the left, so the weight lands on the center.

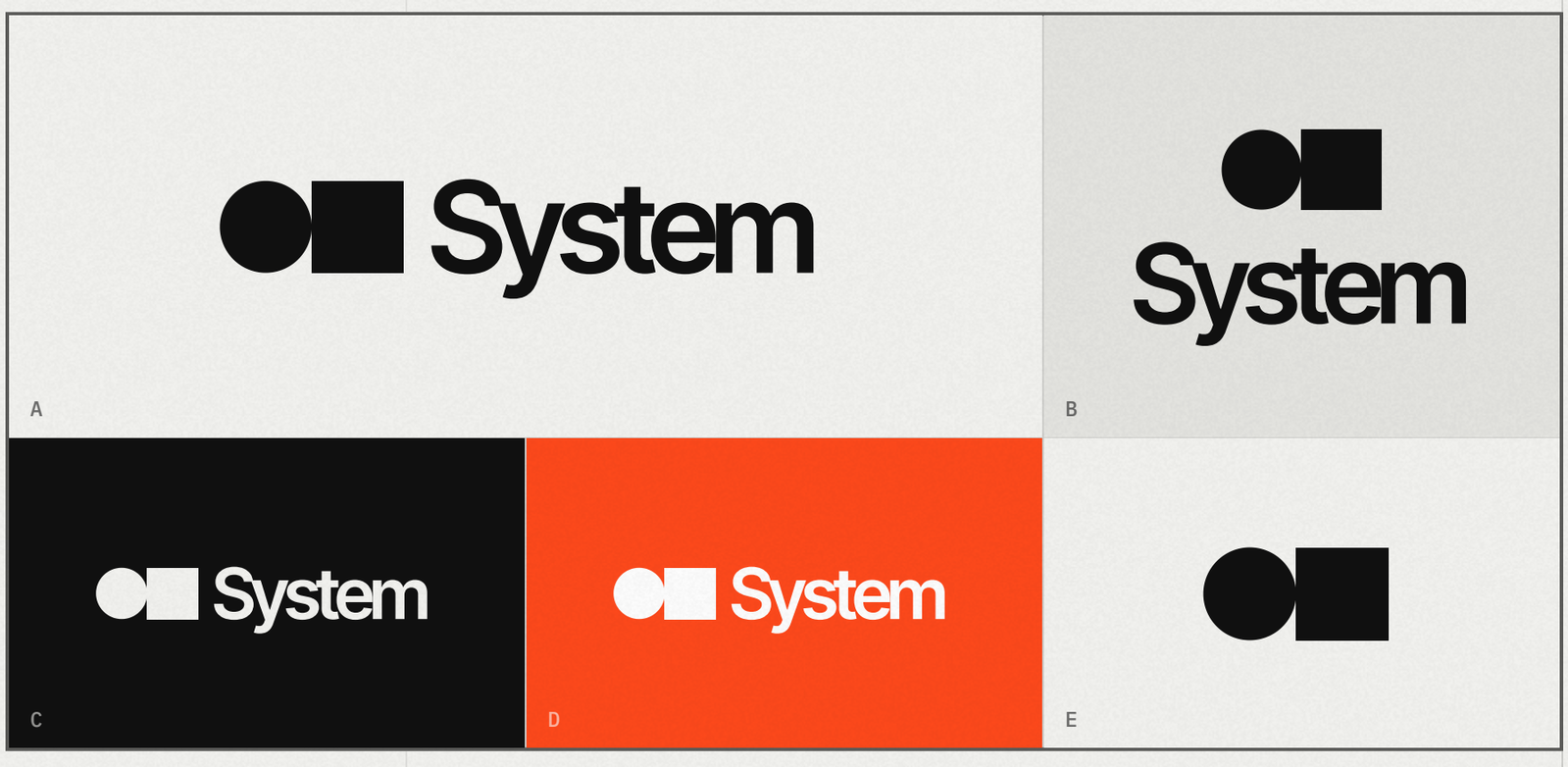
Not in lockups

Next to the name the word balances it. Lockups align on their clear space instead.

LOCKUPS

MIN. 24 PX MARK

- **A** **Primary.** Ink on paper. Use it wherever you can.
- **B** **Stacked.** For square and narrow formats, avatars and stickers.
- **C** **On ink.** Paper on the ink color, for dark screens and the back of cards.
- **D** **Reversed.** White on the accent, once per spread at most.
- **E** **Mark only.** When the name is already on screen, and below 120 px of lockup width.



Color

Paper, ink and three grays do the work. The accent is a drop: one key word, one active state, one full stop.

Paper

HEX	#F4F4F1
RGB	244 244 241
CMYK	0 0 1 4

Ink

HEX	#111111
RGB	17 17 17
CMYK	0 0 0 93

Gray 600

HEX	#5C5C5A
RGB	92 92 90
CMYK	0 0 2 64

Gray 400

HEX	#9A9A96
RGB	154 154 150
CMYK	0 0 3 40

Gray 100

HEX	#E6E6E2
RGB	230 230 226
CMYK	0 0 2 10

Accent

HEX	#FF4A1C
RGB	255 74 28
CMYK	0 71 89 0

PROPORTION

PER LAYOUT, BY AREA



PAPER 60% INK 22% 8% 7% 3%

CONTRAST PAIRS

WCAG 2.2

INK ON PAPER

17.4

AAA

PAPER ON INK

17.4

AAA

GRAY 600 ON PAPER

6.2

AA

WHITE ON ACCENT

3.3

LARGE TEXT ONLY

05 / 16

Typography

2 FAMILIES

One grotesk for everything you read, one mono for everything you measure.
Sizes step on a 1.25 scale and snap to an 8 px baseline.

INTER TIGHT	300 – 600
Aa	
ilmW01{}	

IBM PLEX MONO	400 – 500
Aa	
ilmW01{}	

SCALE	SIZE / LINE HEIGHT
DISPLAY	Start from type 72 / 72
H1	Start from type and grid 48 / 56
H2	Start from type and grid, then add the rest 32 / 40
LEDE	Start from type and grid, then add the logo, the icons and the pictures. 20 / 32
BODY	Start from type and grid, then add the logo, the icons and the pictures when the client has them. 16 / 24
LABEL	START FROM TYPE AND GRID 12 / 16

TYPE TESTER	56 PX · 500
Hairlines, grids & a drop of color	
SIZE — WEIGHT	

WEIGHTS	4
Light	Regular
Medium	Semibold

Grid

8 PX UNIT

Twelve columns on desktop, four on phones. The ruler lines behind this page are the grid itself, so anything off it shows.

COLUMNS

12 × FLUID · 24 GAP · 48 MARGIN

SPACING × 8 PX

S-1		8
S-2		16
S-3		24
S-5		40
S-8		64
S-12		96
S-16		128

BREAKPOINTS MIN WIDTH

NAME	COLUMNS	GAP	WIDTH
Phone	4	16	0
Tablet	12	16	720
Desktop	12	24	1024
Wide	12	24	1440

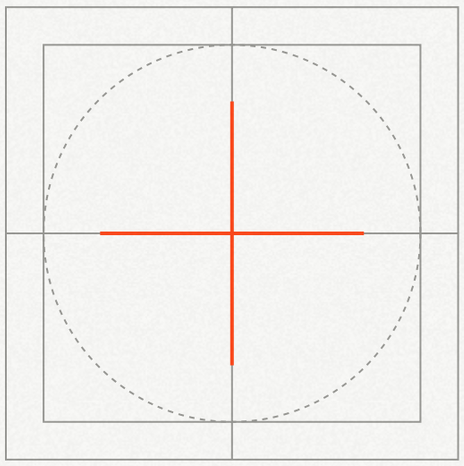
Past 1440 the content stops growing. The ruler lines keep going to the edge of the screen.

Icons

Icons are drawn on a 24 grid with a single 1 px hairline, open ends and no fills, so they sit with the ruler lines.

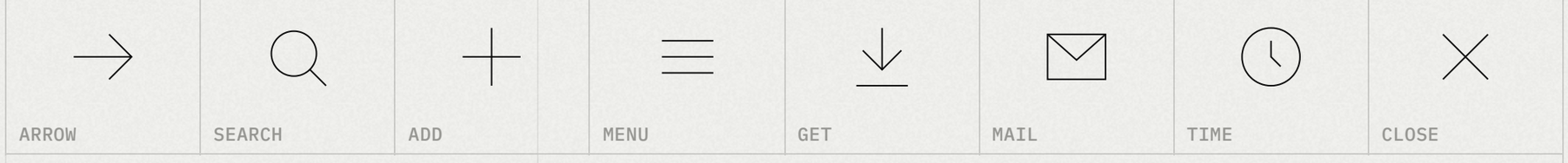
ANATOMY

24 GRID



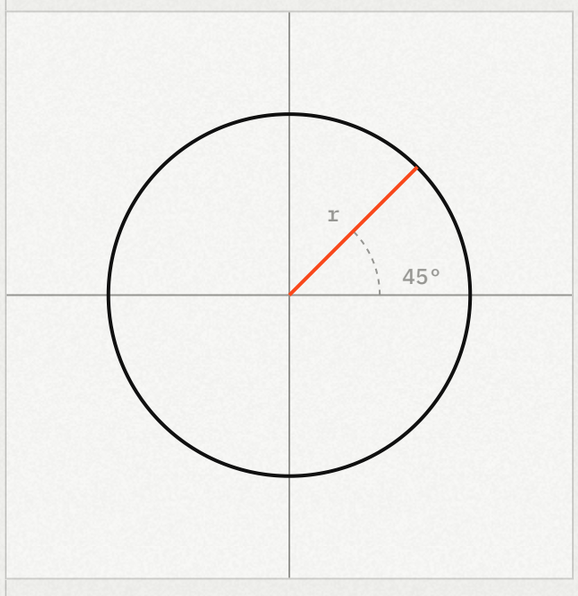
SET

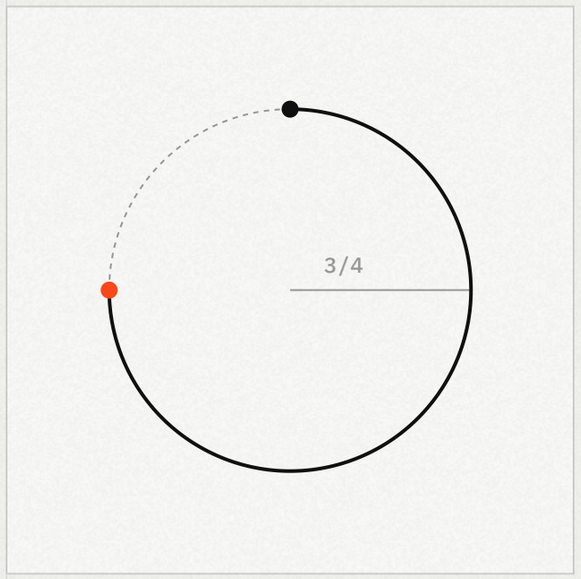
1 PX STROKE · 2 PX PADDING

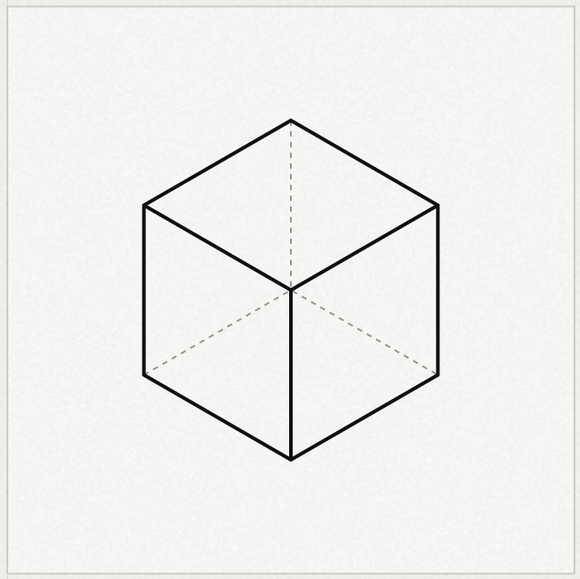


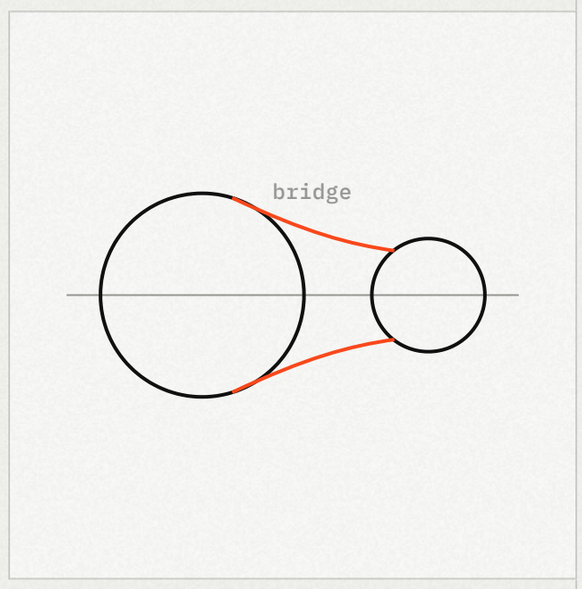
SKETCH SHAPES

ALWAYS AVAILABLE







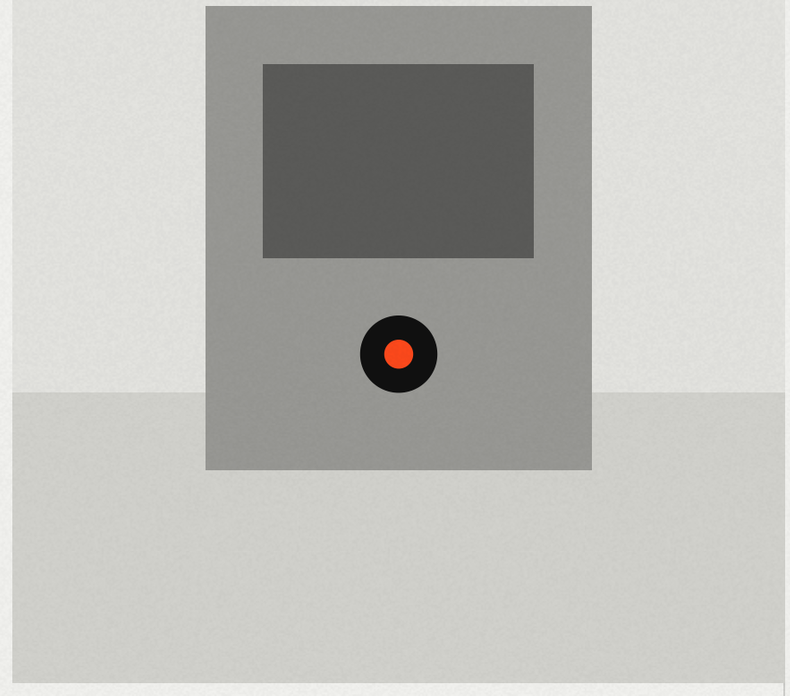


Imagery

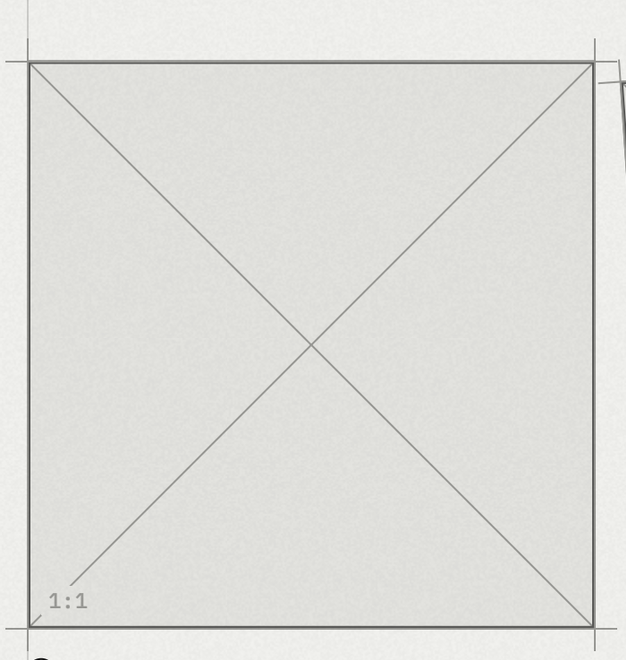
Pictures run in gray, flat and quiet. The accent may appear once per image, on the thing the picture is about.



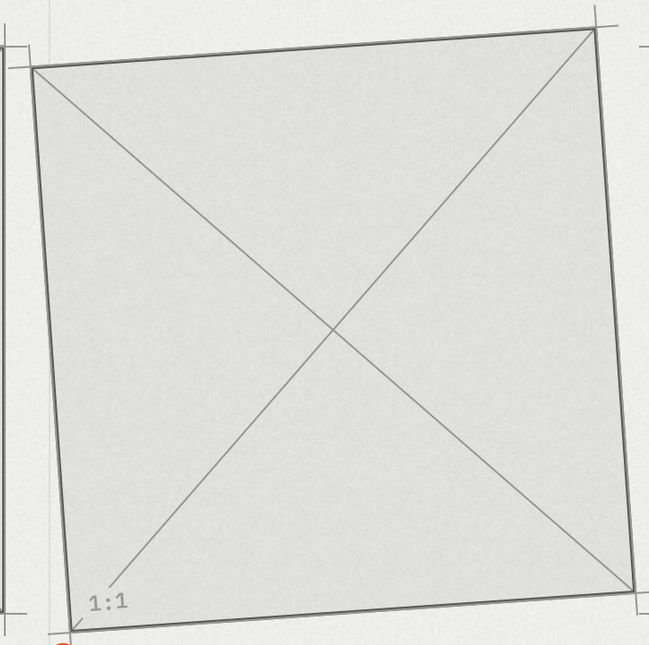
GRAY FLAT · 16:9 · ACCENT ONCE



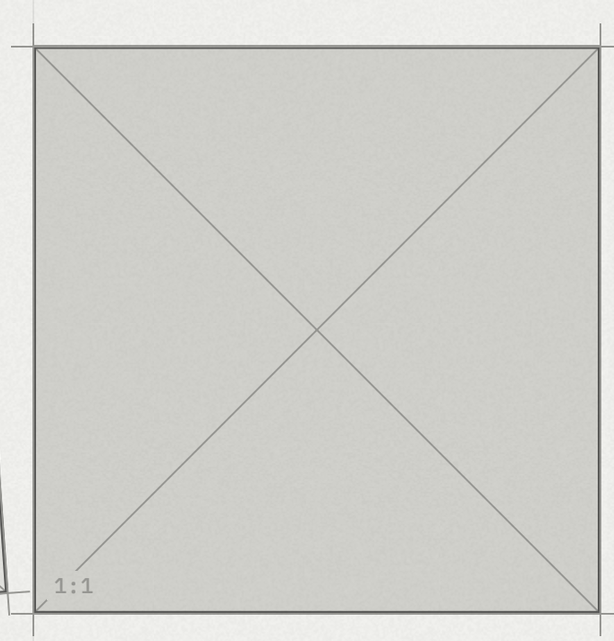
GRAY FLAT · 4:5 · OBJECT



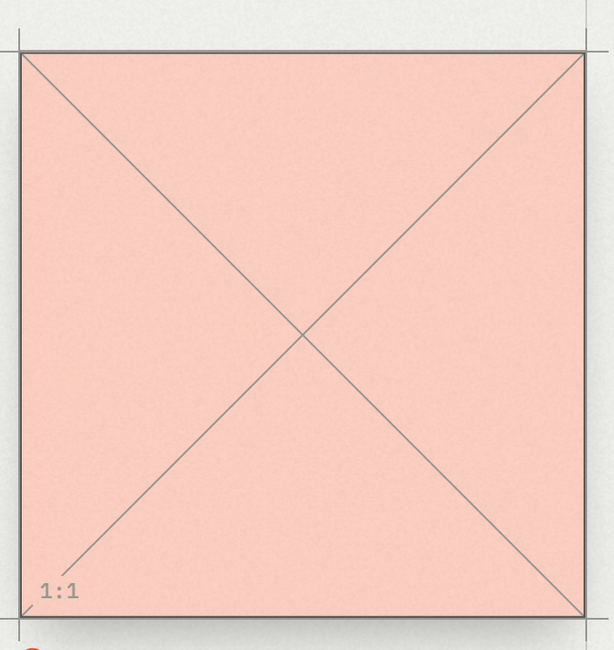
Crop on the grid



Don’t tilt or skew



Gray, one accent at most



No tints or drop shadows

Components

Hairlines instead of boxes, pills for actions, and the accent saved for the one thing the screen wants you to do.

BUTTONS

48 / 32 PX

Primary Secondary Tertiary

Small Small Disabled

CHIPS & CHECKS

24 PX

SELECTED WEB APPS PRINT

☑ Logo ☑ Icons ☐ Imagery

FIELDS

UNDERLINE ONLY

NAME

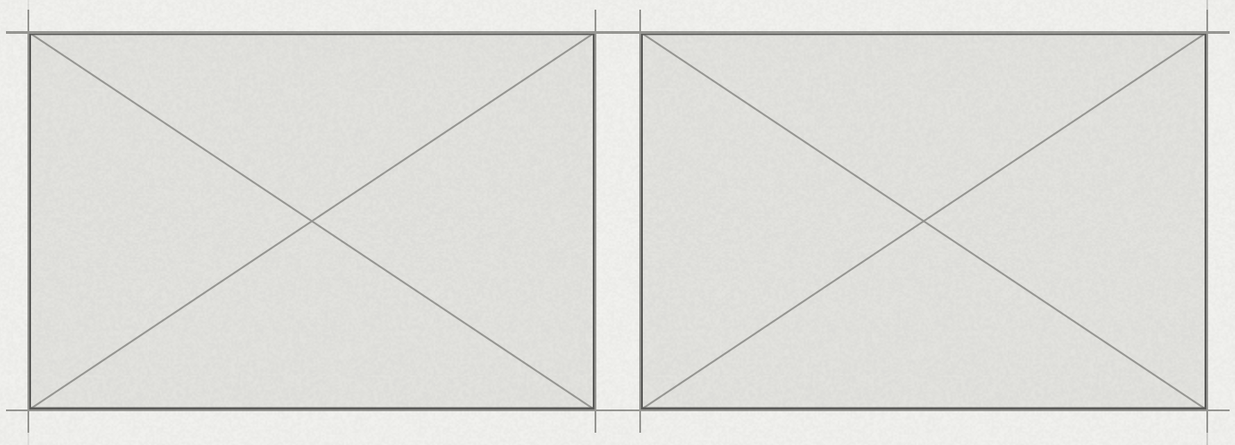
Your name

EMAIL · NEEDS AN @

hello.example.com

CARDS

TOP RULE, NO BOX



Case study

Short summary in two lines at most.

Release notes

What changed and why it matters.

TOKENS

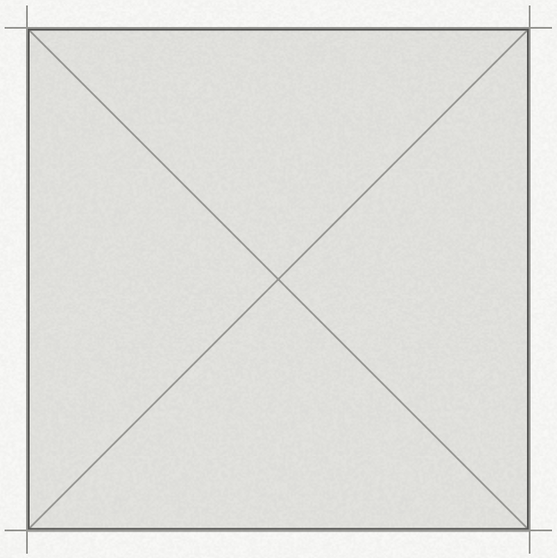
CSS/SYSTEM.CSS

TOKEN	VALUE	USE	DARK
--paper	#F4F4F1	Page background	#111110
--ink	#111111	Text, rules, primary fills	#EEEEEA
--ink-3	#9A9A96	Labels, annotations	#6B6B67
--fill	#E6E6E2	Drafting frames, skeletons	#222220
--accent	#FF4A1C	One thing per screen	#FF4A1C

Apps

Four states every app needs before it needs anything else: the welcome, the empty list, the wait and the error.

01 · WELCOME

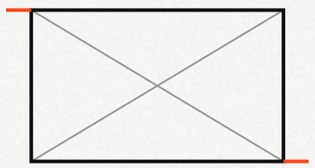


Everything in one place

Your files, your tokens and your manual, always in sync.

Get started

02 · EMPTY



Nothing here yet

Add your first project and it will show up on this page.

Add a project

03 · LOADING





04 · ERROR

ERROR · E-104

We couldn’t reach the server

Check your connection and try again. Your changes are saved on this phone.

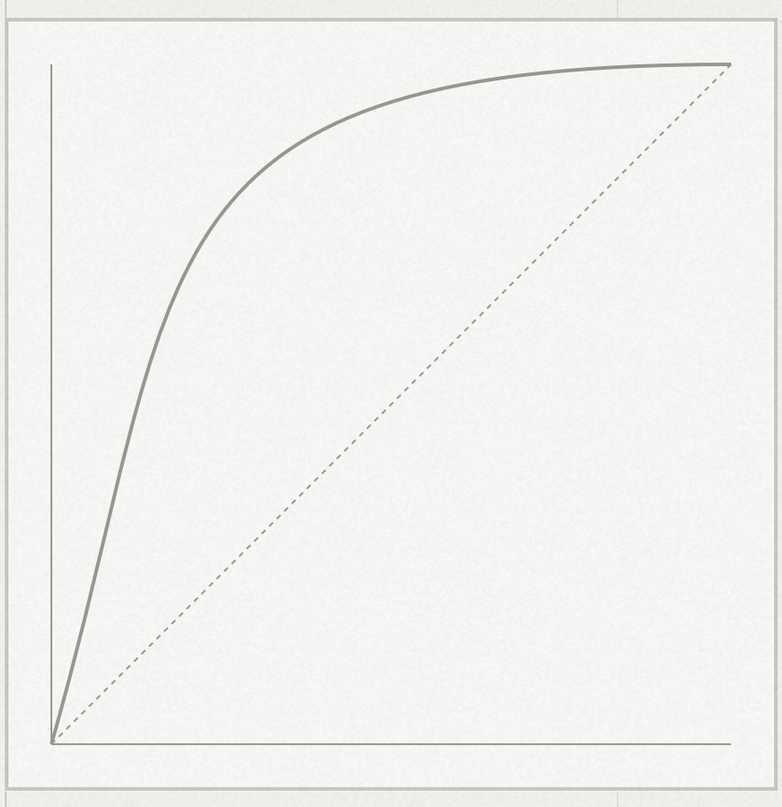
Try again

Motion

HOVER TO PLAY

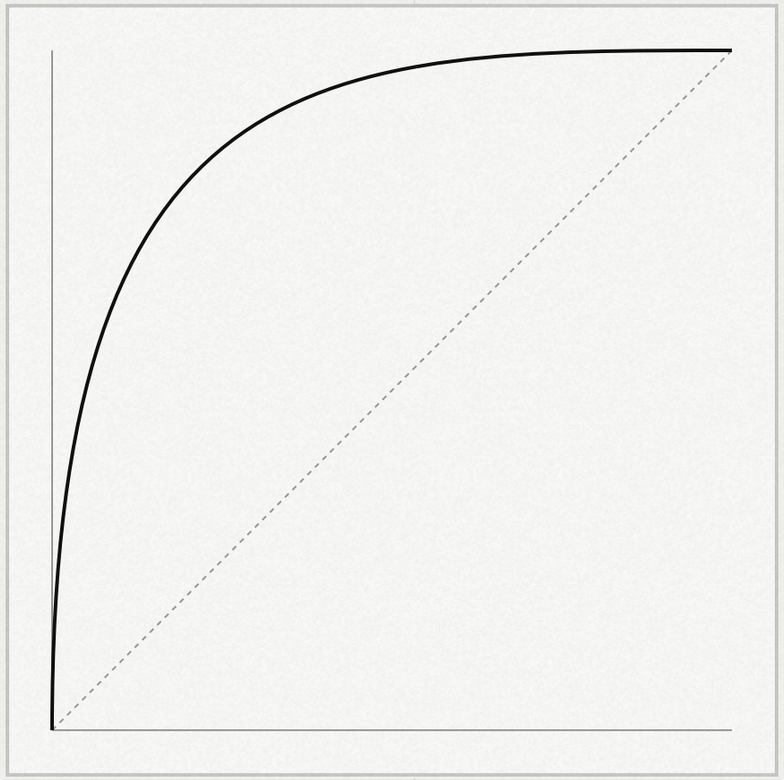
Things arrive fast and settle slowly. Three durations, one curve for most of it, and a spring for anything you drag.

STANDARD 240 MS



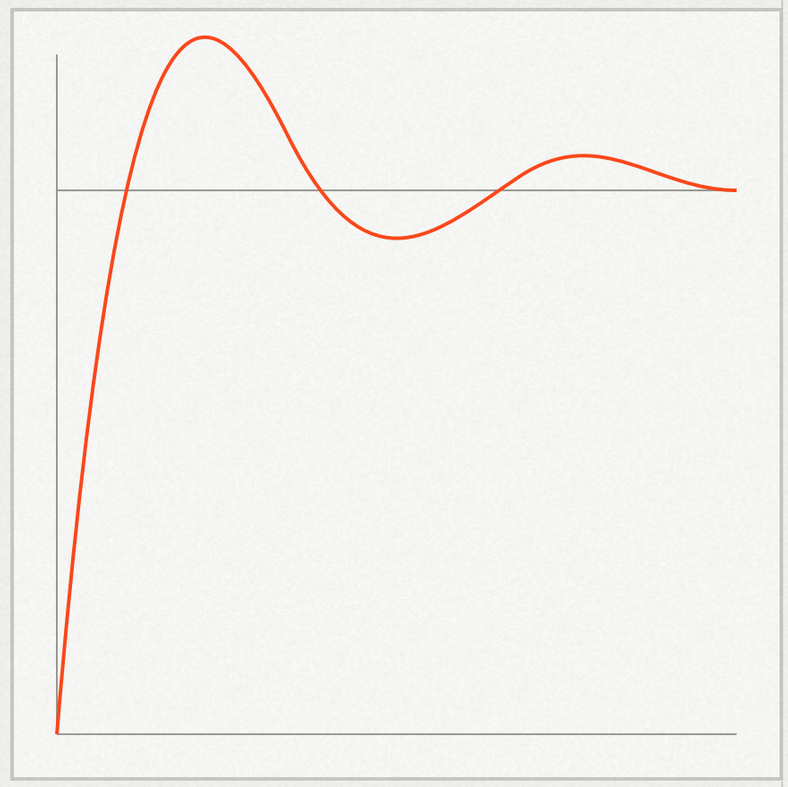
cubic-bezier(.2, .7, .1, 1)

ENTER 400 MS



cubic-bezier(0, 0, .2, 1)

SPRING ≈ 560 MS



stiffness 320 · damping 22

Voice

Write the way the page looks: short, plain, nothing that doesn’t carry weight.
Say what happened and what to do next.

Plain words

“Use”, not “leverage”. “Send”, not “submit”. If a word needs a tooltip, pick another one.

Sentence case

Headings, buttons and labels all start with one capital. Mono labels are the only capitals.

Verbs on buttons

A button says what it does: “Get the files”, never “OK” or “Click here”.

REWRITES

BEFORE → AFTER

BEFORE

~~Oops! Something went wrong. Please try again later.~~

AFTER

We couldn’t reach the server. Your changes are saved, so try again in a minute.

BEFORE

~~Unlock the power of seamless brand synergy today.~~

AFTER

Keep the website, the app and the posters looking like one brand.

Marketing

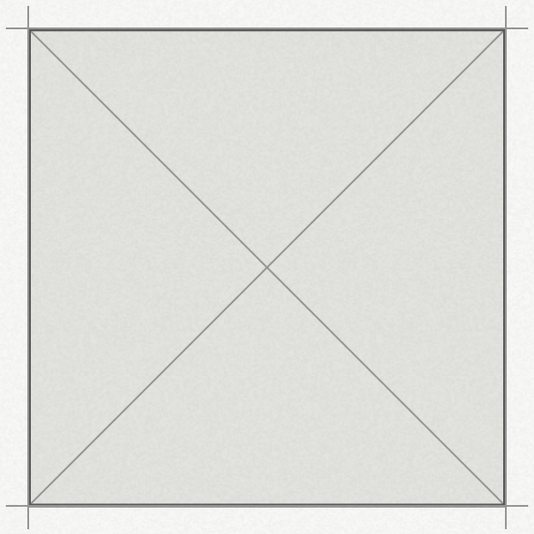
The cover idea at every size: one big line of type, a label in the corner, and the accent on one thing.

SYSTEM 01

Start from type.

POST · 1:1 · 1080 × 1080

STORY 02



Then add the rest

STORY · 9:16 · 1080 × 1920

SYSTEM.EXAMPLE OG

Build the brand once

LINK PREVIEW · 1.91:1 · 1200 × 630

Build the brand once, use it everywhere

Get the files

LEADERBOARD · 728 × 90

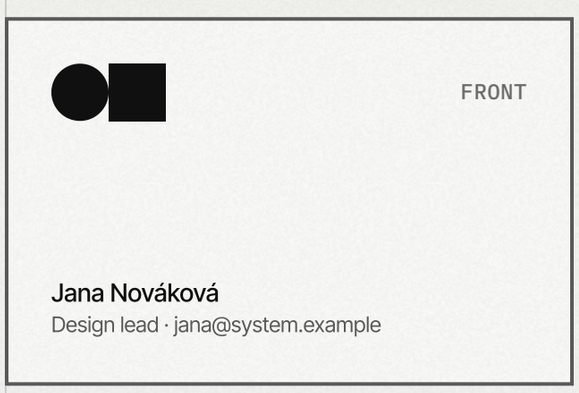
Print

CMYK · 3 MM BLEED

Cards and letterheads use the same grid, scaled to millimeters. Uncoated paper, one ink plus the accent.

BUSINESS CARD

85 × 55 MM

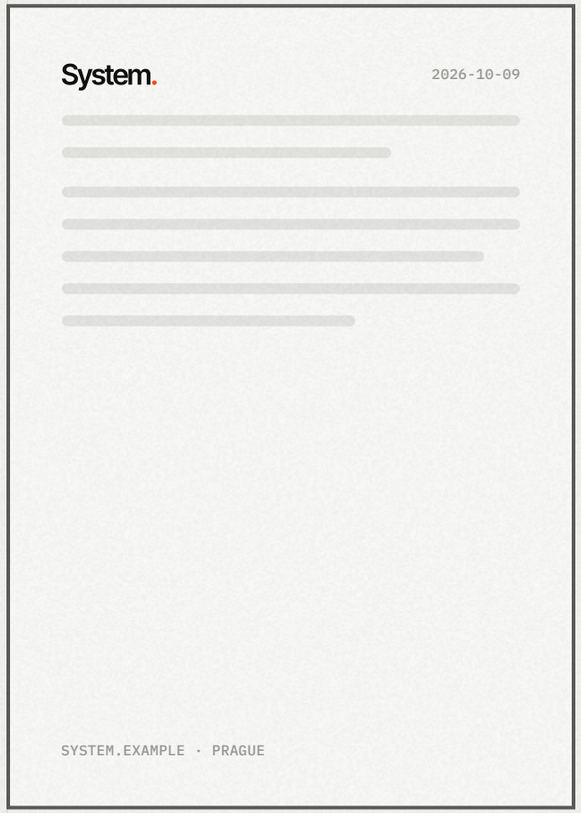


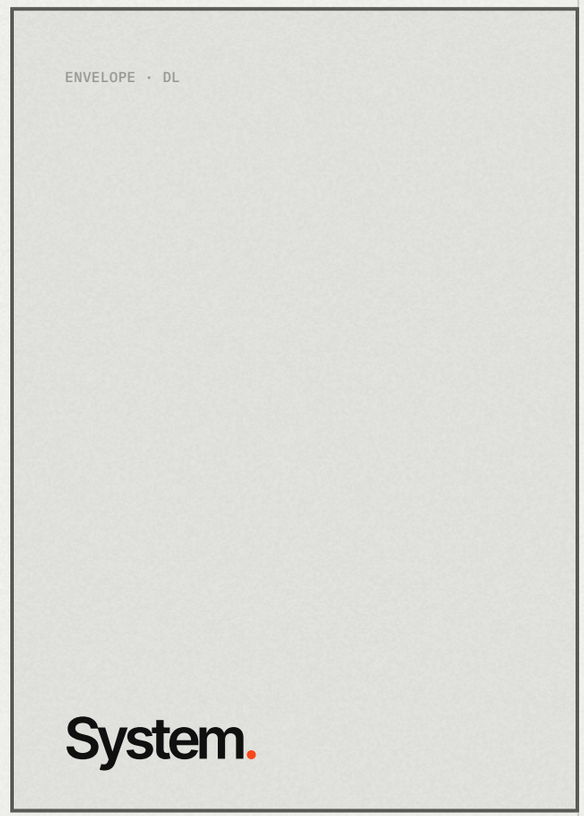


Front in ink on uncoated white, back flooded in ink. The name is the only line set larger than 12 pt.

LETTERHEAD

A4 · 210 × 297 MM





Downloads

Everything on these pages as files, built by one script. Hand over the link and you never send a logo by email again.

Logo package SVG, PNG and PDF, every lockup, clear space built in	ZIP	2.4 MB	Download
Design tokens Color, type and spacing as CSS variables and JSON	CSS · JSON	8 KB	Download
Fonts Inter Tight and IBM Plex Mono, both under the OFL	TTF · WOFF2	1.1 MB	Download
This manual The whole manual as one file, fonts embedded	PDF · HTML	8.5 MB	Download

Utility

The pages nobody designs. They get the same grid and the same voice, and they always offer a way back.

NOT FOUND — 404.HTML

404

This page moved or never existed. The cover is a good place to start again.

Back to the cover

FAVICON — FAVICON.SVG · 32 GRID



CHANGELOG — NEWEST FIRST

1.0	First edition. Sheets 00 to 16, the with/without switches, light and dark.
0.2	The ferrofluid nav, drafting frames and the gray illustration style.
0.1	Tokens, the 8 px grid and the infinite ruler lines.

RULES — LIGHT AND DARK TABS

The mark in a black disc

The circle in the accent, the brand’s dot, and the square in white, on a disc of ink. The disc carries it on light tab strips and dark ones alike, so the icon never follows the system theme.

Optically centered

The mark is 12 units tall on the 32 grid and 24 wide, as large as the disc allows with an even margin, and sits 3% of its width left of center, like the mark alone anywhere else.